



1 NOKIA FAKES AD

Nokia launched the Lumia 920 in late 2012 and released a nice advertisement video highlighting the video quality and most importantly the Optical Image Stabilisation feature. The advertisement looked absolutely brilliant and the picture quality along with the OIS technology seemed really out of this world.

Too bad, Nokia faked that. When the advert was examined frame by frame, there was an instance where a reflective surface revealed that the advert was actually shot using a professional camera crew with a proper setup and not the Nokia Lumia 920. The cat was out of the bag and then Nokia went into damage control. An apology was released where they said that the advert was an attempt to simulate the effects of the new OIS technology and their intention was not to mislead. Along with the apology they released another video which was shot using the Nokia 920 and actually showcased the OIS technology.



4 SILK ROAD TAKEDOWN

No this isn't the ancient silk trading route that we're talking about but a marketplace on the dark web. The dark web is a separate internet on its own with high anonymity. Silk Road was a website where you could indulge in all sorts of illegal activities from buying narcotics, foreign currency and high calibre weapons to hiring hackers and assassins.

The FBI went after Silk Road primarily for the illegal narcotics trade and it took them years before they could zero in on the culprits. This could be attributed to the fact that Silk Road used anonymous cryptocurrencies for most transactions. When the FBI finally took it down they also dismantled a huge chunk of the dark web and took down as many TOR routers as they could. While this was a major loss for the people behind Silk Road it wasn't that long before Silk Road 2.0 reared its ugly head and is still online.

Dead Pirate Roberts, the person behind Silk Road is actually a moniker that was handed down from the previous administrator and it won't be long before the next dead pirate rises.

2 SNOWDEN BLOWOUT

Everyone knew that the United States spies on anyone and everyone on the planet. The sheer scale of this kind of spying had been depicted in varying details in a host of fictional works. Even when little incidents of spying were reported in the media no one paid any attention. That's until Edward Snowden, leaked a bunch of classified documents to the world's media. Things like these had happened before but what added credibility to this person was the fact that he worked for the CIA and then for the NSA. Both hardware and software backdoors were reported to exist in a load of products manufactured by US companies. The German government even released an advisory urging German companies to avoid using software products and services made by American companies. America went to ridiculous an extent of having the Bolivian President's plane forced to land when rumours surfaced that Edward might've been travelling with him.



5 NET NEUTRALITY DEATH

Net neutrality is a concept which requires each and every customer of an ISP to be treated on equal footing. The plan that one subscribes to will affect the bandwidth cap and the data transfer limit (also known as the FUP limit). However, the quality of the connection which includes the contention ratio and routing should be the same. This is what Net Neutrality is all about. What the ISPs in the USA wanted to do was to have two lines. One which has a high contention ratio which means that when a lot of people use the line the quality of the line drastically reduces. The other line would be a premium line where a high quality is maintained even if the number of users sharing the line increases. These ISPs finally had their way when the net neutrality laws were thrown out by the federal court. Indian laws can be described to be archaic compared to the law in the USA and when the legal system in that country goes for a toss our ISPs could be follow suit.

3 MOBILE BENCHMARK CHEATING

One of the ways mobile phone hardware are compared is by running a synthetic benchmark. Antutu and GFXBench are two of the more



popular mobile benchmarking software so when a certain Samsung smartphone achieved a spectacular score people got wary. After all there were other phones with similar hardware but they didn't score well. So someone used the very same benchmark software but gave it a different name. This time the phone didn't give the same score despite multiple runs. Samsung's firmware was then analysed and found to have a little script that increased the processor's capabilities only for benchmarking software. When this little piece of information was released people started following the same process for different phones and a few other manufacturers including HTC, LG and ASUS were found to be cheating in the benchmarks as well. These devices were later de-listed by the benchmarking companies.